NSF I-Corps
Competitive Analysis

Team Name & Number:	**Fruitful Network Development 003**				
Entrepreneurial Lead:	Dylan Montgomery	Mentor:		Academic Lead:	

Understanding Competitors

Identify at least five competitors and their products/services. List the competitive product's features and (if possible) prices, and then differentiate how your product has an OBJECTIVE advantage over the existing product or how it is an improvement on the existing competition. Quantify your value as much as you can. Remember, think creatively to come up with 5 alternative solutions to your offering!

Competitor:	*Product Type:*	*Product Name:*
Wix	Website Services	Website and Website Services
Product Features (e.g. Cost, Performance, Convenience, Reliability):	**Cost**: Offers a free plan with limited features; premium plans start at $16 per month, with advanced plans reaching up to $200 per month, depending on features and storage needs. **Performance**: Provides a user-friendly drag-and-drop interface, AI design assistance, and a variety of templates suitable for various business types. **Convenience**: All-in-one platform including website building, hosting, and domain services. **Reliability**: Boasts a 99.99% uptime, ensuring consistent website availability.	
What makes your product better or different?	Versatility, less cost, allows for greater participation in CSA's and HUB's, allows for greater control centralization of other applications, like social media, quickbooks and other applications employed. Allows these different services to work in succession and be managed from one place. Given that one of these individuals wants to change or bring in house, one time development fees can be paid to FDN to dev. an open source implementation.	

Competitor:	*Product Type:*	*Product Name:*
Shopify	Website Services	Website Services and Point of Sale
Product Features (e.g. Cost, Performance, Convenience, Reliability):	**Cost**: Subscription plans range from $39 per month for basic packages to $2,000 for enterprise-level services; additional costs for hardware and transaction fees apply. **Performance**: Integrates online store capabilities with POS systems, facilitating seamless omnichannel selling. **Convenience**: Centralizes inventory management, payment processing, and sales tracking across online and physical stores. **Reliability**: Generally stable, though some users have reported occasional connectivity issues during peak periods.	
What makes your product better or different?	Similar to Wix, except in the case of add on, in that Shopify offers integration that Wix does not but for recurring charges. Rather than having to pay for rearcuing charges, 3rd party services and applications can be integrated into a business management network or an application can be adapted for the network for a one time fee. Note that the fee for dev. is much lower due to the open source novel technology.	

Competitor:	*Product Type:*	*Product Name:*
Compass Computer grp Inc.	Website MSP	Managed Service Provider
Product Features (e.g. Cost, Performance, Convenience, Reliability):	**Cost**: Pricing is customized based on the specific services required by the client. **Performance**: Offers comprehensive IT services, including network support, hardware and software maintenance, and data backup solutions. **Convenience**: Provides 24/7 support with an average response time of under 15 minutes, minimizing downtime.	

	Reliability: Emphasizes proactive monitoring and rapid issue resolution to ensure system stability.	
What makes your product better or different?	My products allow for these same solution implementations to be provided and maintained at much lower costs due to the lower cost for FDN to do so, due to the open source novel technology.	
Competitor:	*Product Type:*	*Product Name:*
QuickBooks	QuickBooks Desktop Enterprise	Inventory, Shipping, and Distribution Management
Product Features (e.g. Cost, Performance, Convenience, Reliability):	**Cost**: Free to use with a Google account. **Performance**: Strong core inventory features; supports FIFO, bin locations, and barcoding. **Convenience**: Seamless integration with no third-party syncing needed. **Reliability**: Extremely stable due to being native to QuickBooks.	
What makes your product better or different?	Similar advantages to Shopify and their add on, as well as the reasoning for an MSP company like Compass Computer Group Inc. Additionally in both these cases, these solutions are highly restrictive in the users ability to have an integrated network for their specific operations.	
Competitor:	*Product Type:*	*Product Name:*
FaceBook	Community Organizing	Pseudo Website and Profile Blog
Product Features (e.g. Cost, Performance, Convenience, Reliability):	**Cost**: Creating and maintaining a business page is free; advertising incurs additional costs. **Performance**: Enables businesses to engage with a vast user base, share updates, and interact through comments and messages. **Convenience**: Offers tools like Facebook Groups for community engagement and targeted advertising options. **Reliability**: While generally stable, businesses are subject to platform algorithm changes and must adhere to Facebook's policies.	
What makes your product better or different?	Whereas this is currently the best way to reach a community and one of the only main ways to hierarchy create an online community through 'Facebook Groups', the benefits of facebook can be brought into the Network as a local management for all facets of social media. Therefore a post made to an online blog can be made to Facebook as well as any other social media employed. IMPORTANT Secondly, customers that are seeking to buy sustainable and locally may not be able to get all of what they need at one HUB or CSA, or they may want to see if a specific vendor has a stand at a HUB or participates in an CSA closer to them. In the FDN implementation, they are able to freely follow a vendor's HUB/CSA profile to that vendor's websites, as well as see where that vendor participates in HUB/CSA programs. This would only be possible, as of now, with the centralization of an application that must host and curate all this information. In my product I am able to offer vendors the ability to have a website that resides on a framework that is possible, in such a way that HUB/CSA can dev. These curation focused websites draw the information that is already hosted on the vendors websites to fit a profile framework for their curation and thus no double hosting is needed. This same train of thought also goes for the interaction and management of different outgoing destinations, like inventory, youtube, invoices, POS systems; such that a vendor would be able to manage these from one place and automate how they please. All without having to pay subscriptions beyond those specified for hosting, dev. or subscriptions paid for to use 3rd party services that can also now be integrated into the system as a whole to work in succession.	